

Credit Readiness Guide

Understand the credit factors that matter most when preparing to buy a home.



INSIDE THIS GUIDE

How credit is measured, moves to avoid before a mortgage review, and a clear path to prepare your profile.



KNOW WHAT LENDERS SEE

Understand key credit factors.



PROTECT YOUR PROFILE

Avoid common credit missteps.



PREPARE WITH CONFIDENCE

Take smart steps toward homeownership.



**STRONG TODAY.
READY TOMORROW.**

Set your credit up
for homeownership
success.



Mary Vega, REALTOR® • Keller Williams (AZ SA648249000)

Financing: Scott Smith • Citywide Home Mortgage •
NMLS #2244351 (Co. NMLS #2611)



Equal Housing Opportunity. Educational only — not a loan approval, rate quote, commitment to lend, or guarantee of program eligibility.



What Credit Measures

Credit is one part of your buying picture. Understanding the main factors helps you make better decisions.

1

Payment history

Your track record of paying on time is the strongest signal of credit reliability.

2

Utilization

The amount you owe compared with your credit limits shows how you manage available credit.

3

Credit depth

The age, mix, and activity of your credit accounts help tell the full story.

Avoid Moves That Hurt

Some well-intended changes can create problems if they happen right before a mortgage review.

- 1 Opening new accounts**
New credit inquiries can lower your score profile.
- 2 Closing old cards**
Closing accounts may reduce available credit and history.
- 3 Large unplanned payments**
Big deposits or withdrawals can raise questions.

Create a Clear Path

The goal is not perfection. The goal is preparation, clarity, and a plan that fits your timeline.



Review your reports

Pull all three credit reports and check for accuracy and completeness.



Dispute carefully

Dispute inaccuracies before lenders review your profile.



Keep paying on time

Positive history is one of the most powerful paths to better credit.

IMPORTANT NOTE Programs, rates, requirements, and credit use vary. Your loan team will explain exactly what applies to your situation.

Turn This Into a Plan

- 1 Check your reports**
Review your credit reports and understand what lenders see.

- 2 Choose one focus**
Pick one area to improve and take action.

- 3 Talk strategy**
Work with Mary and Scott to build a plan that fits your timeline.

Mary Vega — Your Agent

REALTOR® with Keller Williams, serving West Valley, Arizona. Mary guides you through touring, comparing homes, offers, and closing.

Scott Smith — Your Lender

Mortgage Loan Originator with Citywide Home Mortgage, NMLS #2244351. Scott handles pre-approval, loan options, and financing guidance.

Let's create your plan together.

Schedule your free strategy call at movewithmaryv.com